

012. Chapter 2 Verses 30-31

Lectures by Swami Sarvapriyananda

VERSE 2.30

देही नित्यमवध्योऽयं देहे सर्वस्य भारत ।
तस्मात्सर्वाणि भूतानि न त्वं शोचितुमर्हसि ॥ 30 ॥

dehī nityamavadhyo'yaṃ
dehe sarvasya bhārata |
tasmātsarvāṇi bhūtāni
na tvam śocitumarhasi ||

- ◆ **dehī** - the dweller in the body; **nityam** - always; **avadhyaḥ** - cannot be slain; **ayam** - this;
- ◆ **dehe** - in the body; **sarvasya** - of all; **bhārata** - O Bharata;
- ◆ **tasmāt** - therefore; **sarvāṇi** - for all; **bhūtāni** - beings;
- ◆ **na** - not; **tvam** - you; **śocitum** - to grieve; **arhasi** - should.

O Arjuna! The Self existing in the body of all beings is never slain. So it is not right for you to grieve for any creature.

VERSE 2.31

स्वधर्ममपि चावेक्ष्य न विकम्पितुमर्हसि ।
धर्म्याद्धि युद्धाच्छ्रेयोऽन्यत्क्षत्रियस्य न विद्यते ॥ 31 ॥

svadharmamapi cāvekṣya
na vikampitumarhasi |
dharmyāddhi yuddhācchreyo'nyat
kṣatriyasya na vidyate ||

- ◆ **svadharmam** - own duty; **api** - also; **ca** - and; **avekṣya** - considering;
- ◆ **na** - not; **vikampitum** - to waver; **arhasi** - you should;
- ◆ **dharmyāt** - than righteous; **hi** - indeed; **yuddhāt** - than war; **śreyaḥ** - better; **anyat** - other;
- ◆ **kṣatriyasya** - for a kshatriya; **na** - not; **vidyate** - exists.

And moreover, considering your own duty, you should not waver, for, there is nothing higher for a Kshatriya than a righteous war.